2026 Festival Holiday Calendar & Leave Rules

HR Policies | Version 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026

IMPORTANT: This is a fictional sample document created for HRMS demonstration/testing. It is not an official company policy or legal advice. Replace organization-specific details and have HR/legal teams review it before real-world use.

1. Purpose and scope

This sample guide outlines how an organization may publish festival holidays and administer employee leave during the 2026 calendar year. It applies to regular employees unless a contract or local rule states otherwise.

2. Illustrative holiday calendar

Dates below are planning placeholders and should be verified against official government notifications and the organization's operating calendar before publication.

Holiday / occasion	Indicative date (2026)	Planning note
Republic Day	26 January	National holiday; confirm local applicability
Holi	4 March (illustrative)	Regional observance may vary
Good Friday	3 April (illustrative)	Confirm applicable holiday list
Independence Day	15 August	National holiday
Gandhi Jayanti	2 October	National holiday
Diwali	8 November (illustrative)	Confirm regional calendar
Christmas	25 December	Confirm business coverage needs

3. Leave categories

- Casual leave: short personal needs, subject to the company's annual entitlement and approval process.
- Sick leave: illness or medical needs; supporting documentation may be requested where lawful and reasonable.
- Earned/privilege leave: planned time off accrued according to company rules and applicable law.
- Compensatory off: time off granted for eligible work on a weekly off or holiday, where approved.
- Unpaid leave: may be considered when paid balances are exhausted, subject to approval.

4. Request and approval process

- Submit leave through the HRMS before the planned absence whenever possible.
- The reporting manager reviews team coverage and approves or rejects the request in the system.
- For sudden illness or emergencies, notify the manager as soon as practicable and regularize the request later.
- Employees should check the HRMS leave balance and approval status before making non-refundable travel plans.

5. General rules

- Holiday dates and leave entitlements must be validated for the employee's work location.
- Leave approval is subject to applicable law, company policy, and operational requirements.

- Managers should apply rules consistently and avoid discriminatory treatment.
- Questions or corrections should be directed to the HR team.

6. Document control

Owner: Human Resources | Review cycle: Annual | Status: Sample / requires HR approval